

Tasin Academy

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(Unit–11; Lesson–3(A), by Mahmud Bala wi, Born 1995)

I want to write the most beautiful words about Gaza but I can't. I can't see the poverty, siege and famine, especially when all Gaza city flooded into Al-Areesh and emptied it from all goods in two hours. I can't see the deprivation in every house, the fear and the sickness.

What do you want me to say about Gaza? From when I became aware of it, I was sad about everything inside it. Especially in the kids and even the adults, youth, women, girls. I'm looking for nice words to say but I can't find them. When I stand on the shore I can imagine Cyprus, travel to Paris, fly to Rome. The sea is the only thing that helps me dream. When I stand on the shore I can imagine the whole world and at the end I go back to the reality of Gaza. I go around the refugee camp. I go back to the small house, the dirty market, overflowing sewage, the carts, the suffocating smell, and the silent people who can't speak.

When I look at the clock, my heart beats faster. I feel that the war started again. Not only the clock scares me—everything that flies does, even the flies. I can't tell anyone about my fear so they don't call me a wimp or a sissy. I'm most scared for my older brothers. When a fly lands on any of them, I feel it's going to kill him. I start shouting and I run away from the place. That's why I'm now escaping outside the house all the time, because of the many flies.

1A. Multiple Choice Questions

1. **What is the passage mostly about?**
 - i) Dreams of a refugee
 - ii) Life in Rome
 - iii) Love for Gaza
 - iv) The suffering in Gaza
 2. **What helps the writer escape reality?**
 - i) Silence in the camp
 - ii) Imagining the sea
 - iii) Talking to his brothers
 - iv) Watching the flies
 3. **What scares the narrator most?**
 - i) War sounds
 - ii) The dark
 - iii) Flies
 - iv) Big houses
 4. **Where does the writer imagine traveling to?**
 - i) Gaza City and Al-Areesh
 - ii) Turkey and Syria
 - iii) Rome and Paris
 - iv) Dhaka and Delhi
 5. **What makes the writer feel worse at 11:55?**
 - i) Hunger
 - ii) The clock and the flies
 - iii) Seeing the sky
 - iv) Watching others leave
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1B. Short Questions

- Why can't the writer say beautiful words about Gaza?
- How does the writer describe the refugee camp?
- What gives the writer the power to dream?
- What effect do flies have on the narrator?
- Why is the narrator afraid of being called a sissy?

2. Table Completion

What/Who	Events/Descriptions	What/Where	When/How
Writer	Wants to write about Gaza	But can't say (i) -----	Due to war and deprivation
Gaza city	Flooded into Al-Areesh	Emptied the shops	In (ii)----- hours
Sea	Inspires dreaming	While standing at the shore	Helps escape (iii) -----
Writer's fear	Triggered by time	Especially (iv) -----	Looking at the clock
Refugee camp	Described as overcrowded	With sewage and (v) -----	Writer roams there
People	Silent and helpless	Can't (vi) -----	Due to ongoing trauma
Flies	Cause panic and fear	Remind of (vii) -----	Writer runs away from them
Writer's imagination	Travels the world	Goes to (viii) -----	While standing by the sea
Writer's brothers	Target of his fear	When flies land on (ix) -----	He feels they will get harmed
Market	Overflowing and dirty	Part of the refugee camp	Adds to suffocating (x) -----

Or,

Read the above passage and make a flowchart showing the realities of Gaza. (One is done for you.) **2x5=10**

1. The realities of Gaza like the dirty market	→	2	→	3	→	4	→	5	→	6
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3. Summary Writing

Write a summary of the passage in your own words. Focus on the writer's inner emotions, the condition of Gaza and the refugee camp, and how imagination becomes his only escape from harsh reality.

_____ **Best Of Luck** _____